



The Journal for Cultural and Religious Theory (JCRT)

2.1 |

Artist's Statement

Christopher M Taylor; Christopher M Taylor

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Christopher M. Taylor

Someone who senses himself rebuked by modernism's custody of seriousness may say, as if expressing a new freedom of the arts, that now anything can be exhibited and so tried as art. But that is just the problem, that perhaps all you can do with your work and works is to exhibit them, that all hope for acknowledgment by and of the self is to be foregone, and all authority in one's intentions, all belief in one's beliefs-stares of amusement and boredom replacing all acceptance and real rejection.

--Stanley Cavell, *The World Viewed* [¹]

My slide projection pieces each consist in the projection of two separate slides, from two separate projectors, onto a wall to form a single picture. The slides are colored and marked by hand using colored acetate and masking tape. The projectors are set on stands approximately three-and-a-half feet high, and are placed one next to the other in plain view in the exhibition space-usually about fourteen feet away from the wall at which they project. As such, these are pictures (I often refer to them as "projected pictures", to be precise) supported by a number of material elements: the two slides, the light, the assorted mechanisms of the projectors, and the wall. Moreover, they are pictures the temporal dimensions of which seem to involve both the instantaneity of viewing a flat, vertical image; and the duration of watching the horizontal unfolding of an event (i.e., in being projected through the space between the projectors and the wall, the pictures are continuously being constituted through that space-a quality that is further emphasized when the seams and layers of the pictures are revealed by the movement of viewers within the beams of light). In each of these pieces it is my intention that they somehow acknowledge the significance of these conditions as constitutive of their medium. Stating my interests this way may immediately bring to mind Clement Greenberg's reductivist theories of modern art, whereby individual disciplines are said to search for the one essential and defining quality at the core of their respective practices. However, in exploring my medium, I find no singularity, no "ground zero", at its "core". Rather, I find division and dispersion.

The Exhibit

Notes

Christopher M. Taylor is an artist who lives in Columbus, OH and teaches in the Department of Art at Ohio State University. Born in Norwalk, CN and raised in Somers, NY, he received a BFA in painting from SUNY Purchase in 1992 and an MFA in painting from Ohio State University in 1996. His art work has been exhibited in Berkeley, CA; Columbus, OH; New York City, NY; and Berlin, Germany.

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Updated 07/28/21.
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[^1] Stanley Cavell. *The World Viewed* (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 1971), 120.